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Bar Graphs

Table of Contents

Confidence Levels

Notes

Bookmarks

Highlights

Toolbox

Bar Graphs

Bar Graphs

Graphs give a visual picture of data. In a bar graph, data is represented by the height (or length) of data bars. The bars may be drawn vertically or horizontally.

For the bar graph in the Example below, you can use the title (Cafeteria Orders at Newark High School) and axis labels to determine what values are being compared. The horizontal axis shows the type of meal ordered. The vertical axis shows the number of meals ordered during the week.

Example

Hide

About how many orders of chicken finger meals were sold at Newark High School from 9/15 to 9/19?

Cafeteria Orders at Newark High School 9/15–9/19

Number of Meals Ordered

290

280

270

260

250

240

230

220

210

Mac & Cheese

Chicken Fingers

Pizza

Lasagna

Grilled Cheese Sandwich

Turkey Sandwich

Meal Option

Find the bar labeled Chicken Fingers. Read the value on the vertical axis closest to the height of the bar.

You may need to estimate values on a bar graph. The bar for chicken fingers is about halfway between 240 and 250. **About 245 chicken finger meals** were sold from 9/15 to 9/19.

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Lesson 1: Graphs and Tables

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